

UTT Chapter 12 Assignment

Hello there!

This weekend was *awesome*! The gang met up at the front lawn to play some ultimate Frisbee while we still have a warm spell. I was not expecting so many really good players here, but boy was I wrong! We had three different teams, so each team alternated games. After about four hours, everyone was wiped out. Sarah didn't play, so she brought smoothies for everyone. We really needed them after all that running. Nathan and I had an epic moment where he threw the Frisbee over the head of the tallest guy, and I miraculously caught it while running into the in-zone. Paige was taking pictures during all the games, and she managed to capture that play on camera. Needless to say, that picture will be on my wall as soon as she prints it. Overall, we placed second, but it was still a blast. If it doesn't snow next weekend, we might meet up again for round two.

School has not been busy lately, so I have had more time to just relax and catch up on some reading. I finished C. S. Lewis's Space Trilogy last week. Have you read it? If not, you definitely should. C. S. Lewis is a fantastic author. My favorite was the last book, *That Hideous Strength*. All of the bioethics stuff was really interesting, especially since I am taking biology. It is crazy to imagine what science could do without the ethical boundaries like we talked about a few weeks ago.

In my Intro to Psychology class, we have been learning about theories of human behavior. This week, the class focused specifically on behaviorism. Behaviorism is basically an approach in psychology that sees humans as stimulus receptors who respond in predetermined ways to their environment. B.F. Skinner, the founder of behaviorism, taught that everything is learned through interactions with the environment. We are shaped solely by the world around us. Apparently this is not as prominent now as it used to be.

Sarah, Mark, Paige, and I were talking about it over coffee. I guess Sarah took the class last semester. She began talking about the third-force psychology. In an effort to avoid looking ignorant, I didn't bother asking her what "third force psychology" was. Mark went on to say that behaviorism doesn't make sense because it cannot account for free will. He mentioned Pavlov and tied his research to the dialectic. **How does Secularism view psychology?** And **how does Marxism view psychology?** Paige chimed into the conversation saying we cannot understand the self as a unified entity. Instead, we have a multiplicity of selves. I don't really understand what that means. **How does Postmodernism view psychology?** As I was talking with Mark and Paige, I began to wonder how Nathan, as a New Spiritualist, would think about the soul. **How does New Spirituality view the concept of the self?** I know the Bible teaches that human beings are fallen and composed of immaterial souls. I bet this affects how we practice psychology. **What is the Christian view of psychology?**

Well it is already past midnight here. I guess that means I should get some sleep before my 8:30 a.m. class tomorrow. Thanks again for all your help! You're the best.

Talk to you soon,
-Doug